Present simple: affirmative and negative

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Use the present simple for habits and facts (costumbres y verdades)
- Add -s or -es with he, she and it
- Make negative sentences with don't and doesn't
- Write true sentences about you and your family

Para pensar

En inglés decimos «I play», «you play», «we play»... pero «she plays». ¿De dónde sale esa s?

Explicación

When do we use it?

We use the present simple for things that happen **again and again** (habits): «I **walk** to school every day», «We **play** football on Saturdays». We also use it for things that are **always true** (facts): «Cows **eat** grass», «The sun **rises** in the east».

En castellano: es como nuestro presente cuando hablamos de costumbres: «como fruta todos los días», «los gatos duermen mucho». No sirve para lo que está pasando justo ahora; para eso hay otro tiempo que verás más adelante.



I, you, we, they: easy!

With **I, you, we** and **they**, the verb doesn't change. It's the same word you find in the dictionary: «I **like** apples», «You **like** apples», «We **like** apples», «They **like** apples».

This is great news! In Spanish we say «me gusta, te gusta, nos gusta...», with different endings. In English, for four persons, the verb is **exactly the same**. Remember that *you* means «tú» and also «vosotros»: «You **live** in Bilbao» can be one person or a group.

Person	Verb
I / You	play
We / They	play
He / She / It	plays

He, she, it: add -s

With he, she and it we add **-s** to the verb: «He **plays** the guitar», «She **reads** comics», «It **rains** a lot in Galicia».

This also happens with names and with one person or thing: «**Marta** swims», «**My dad** cooks», «**The dog** barks». A good trick: if you can change the subject for *he, she* or *it*, put the **-s**. **En castellano:** piensa en la «s» como una pegatina que solo llevan él, ella y ello.



My dad → he → cooks

Spelling: -s, -es, -ies

Most verbs just add **-s**: play → play**s**, like → like**s**, eat → eat**s**. But verbs ending in **-sh, -ch, -ss, -x** and **-o** add -es: watch → watch**es**, wash → wash**es**, go → go**es**, do → do**es**.

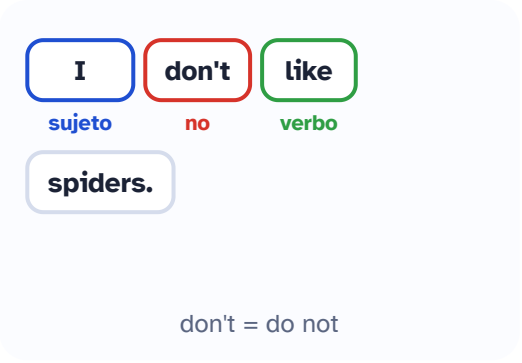
Verbs ending in **consonant + y** change to -ies: study → stud**ies**, fly → fl**ies**. But if there is a vowel before the y, just add -s: play → play**s**. And one special verb: have → **has**. «She **has** a brother.»



Negative: don't

To say **no**, we put don't (do not) before the verb: «I **don't like** spiders», «We **don't go** to school on Sunday», «They **don't eat** meat».

We use *don't* with **I, you, we, they**. **En castellano:** es nuestro «no»: «no me gustan las arañas». Pero fíjate: en inglés no basta con poner *not* delante («I not like»), necesitamos la palabrita ayudante **do**. Es como un amigo que viene a ayudar al verbo cuando decimos que no.



Negative: doesn't

With **he, she, it** the helper changes to doesn't (does not): «She **doesn't like** spiders», «My cat **doesn't eat** vegetables», «It **doesn't snow** in Seville».

Very important: the -s goes to *doesn't*, so the verb **loses its -s**. We say «He doesn't **play**», never «He doesn't plays». **En castellano:** la «s» no puede estar dos veces. Si ya la lleva *does*, el verbo vuelve a su forma normal.



Time words

The present simple often comes with time words that show repetition: **every day** (todos los días), **every week**, **on Mondays** (los lunes), **at the weekend** (el fin de semana), **in summer**.

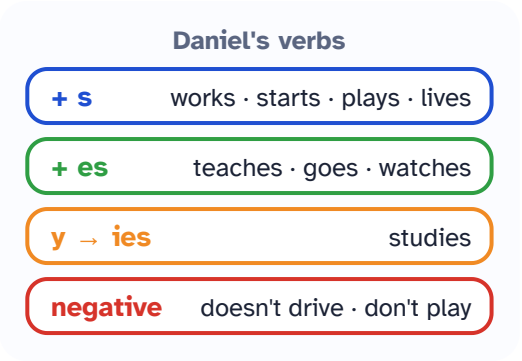
They usually go at the **end** of the sentence: «I have English **on Tuesdays**», «We go to the beach **in summer**». **En castellano:** fíjate que en inglés los días de la semana se escriben siempre con **mayúscula**: Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday... ¡En español no!



Reading: my family's habits

Read Daniel's text: «My family is very busy. My mum **works** in a hospital. She **starts** work at seven. My dad **teaches** maths. He **doesn't drive** to work: he **goes** by bus. My sister Ana **studies** a lot and she **plays** the piano. I **don't play** the piano, but I **love** football. We all **have** dinner together at eight. My grandpa **lives** with us and he **watches** the news every night.»

Find three verbs with **-s**, one with **-es** and one with **-ies**. Who doesn't drive?



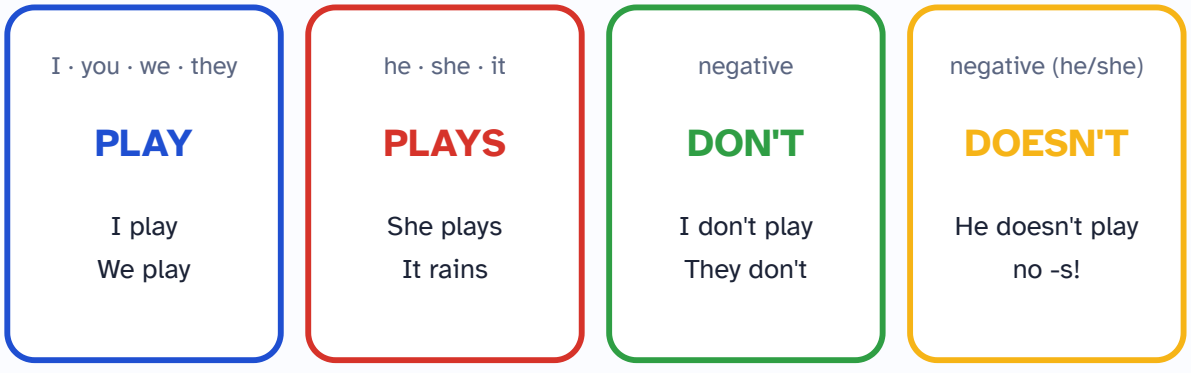
Let's practise: true or false?

Play this game in pairs. Write four sentences about your partner, two affirmative and two negative: «Carla **likes** cats», «Carla **doesn't eat** fish». Then read them aloud. Your partner says «**True!**» or «**False!**» and corrects you: «False! I **don't like** cats. I **like** dogs».

Consejo: antes de leer, revisa cada frase. Si el sujeto es él o ella, ¿lleva el verbo la **s**? En las negativas con *doesn't*, ¿has quitado la **s** del verbo? Si lo haces bien, ¡ganas un punto!



Present simple



Ejercicios

1. **Write the -s form: read, swim, cook.**

2. **Write the -es form: wash, go, catch.**

3. **Write the third person: study, cry, play.**

4. **Complete: «My brother ___ (have) a bike.»**

5. **Complete with don't or doesn't: «We ___ like rain.»**

6. **Complete with don't or doesn't: «The baby ___ walk.»**

7. **Make it negative: «Lola speaks French.»**

8. **Correct: «He don't watch TV.»**

9. **Translate: «Mi gato duerme en el sofá.»**

10. **Write two true sentences about a friend (one negative).**

Practica

1. **«She ___ comics.»**
   - **A)** read
   - **B)** reades
   - **C)** reads
2. **«They ___ in Valencia.»**
   - **A)** live
   - **B)** lives
   - **C)** livs
3. **The -s form of «watch» is...**
   - **A)** watchs
   - **B)** watches
   - **C)** watchies
4. **The -s form of «study» is...**
   - **A)** studys
   - **B)** studies
   - **C)** studyes
5. **«He ___ a sister.»**
   - **A)** haves
   - **B)** have
   - **C)** has
6. **«I ___ like spiders.»**
   - **A)** don't
   - **B)** doesn't
   - **C)** not
7. **«My dog ___ eat apples.»**
   - **A)** don't
   - **B)** isn't
   - **C)** doesn't
8. **Which is correct?**
   - **A)** He doesn't plays.

B) He doesn't play.

C) He don't play.

9. **We use the present simple for...**

A) habits

B) what is happening now

C) the past

10. **Which is written correctly?**

A) on Monday

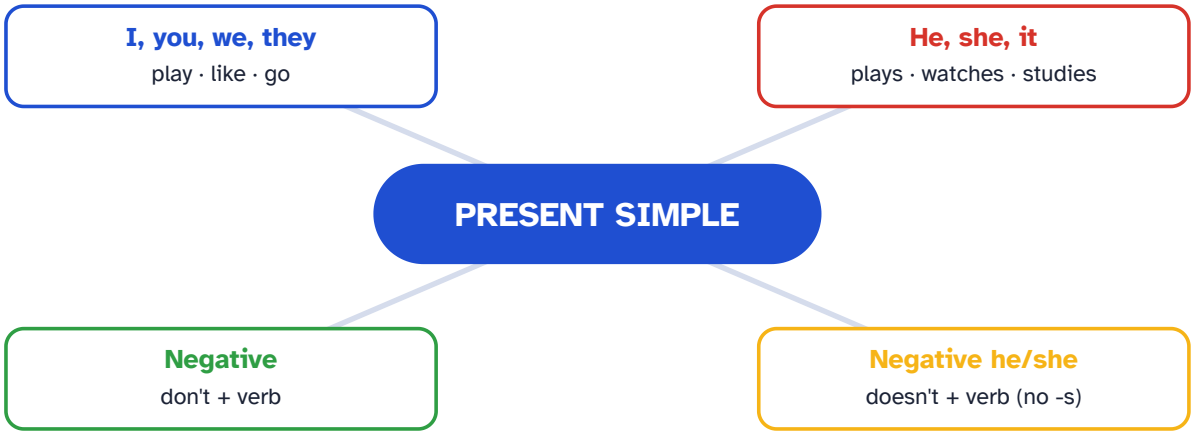
B) on monday

C) On monday

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve el presente simple; Por qué el verbo lleva -s con he, she, it; Las reglas de -s, -es, -ies y el verbo has; Cómo se forma la negativa con don't y doesn't.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

present simple

Costumbres y verdades: I walk to school.

he / she / it + s

She plays. It rains.

-es

watch → watches · go → goes.

-ies

study → studies.

have → has

She has a dog.

don't

No (I, you, we, they).

doesn't

No (he, she, it); el verbo sin s.

on Mondays

Los lunes (con mayúscula).

Soluciones

1. **C)** she + s.
2. **A)** they sin s.
3. **B)** -ch + es.
4. **B)** consonante + y → ies.
5. **C)** have → has.
6. **A)** I + don't.
7. **C)** dog = it.
8. **B)** Sin s tras doesn't.
9. **A)** Costumbres.
10. **A)** Días con mayúscula.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. reads, swims, cooks.
2. washes, goes, catches.
3. studies, cries, plays.
4. has.
5. don't.
6. doesn't.
7. Lola doesn't speak French.
8. He doesn't watch TV.
9. My cat sleeps on the sofa.
10. Model answer: Hugo likes basketball. He doesn't like milk.